

Education System

Meiji period -> introduced educational changes in Japan.

-> adopted a western style curriculum with vocational schools -> to support its industrialization efforts.

=> education system reinforced Japanese loyalty to the emperor, the state, family and community.

education + media such as newspapers and films -> encouraged nationalistic feelings among the Japanese.

Besides stressing -> that Japan was ever colonized by western powers -> education system also highlighted the country's economic development by early 1900s and celebrated its stability and unity.

Japanese education -> praised military -> military drills were part of the curriculum.

military's importance -> in protecting Japan from enemies - particularly western powers which had colonized much of Asia -> was emphasized.

Military's successes -> during Sino-Japanese war and Russo-Japanese war -> were also celebrated.

-> hence military was highly respected in society and was influential in the rise of Japanese militarism.